Probato

Business Plan

Autonomous AI-Powered QA Testing Platform

YOUR AI QA AGENT — TEST, FIX, SHIP

Feature Discovery | Autonomous Testing | Code Fixing | Security Testing | Multi-Device | Media Verification

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1. Executive Summary

Probato is an autonomous AI-powered QA testing platform that represents a fundamental shift in how software quality assurance is performed. Named from the Latin *probator*, meaning "examiner, one who tests and proves," Probato deploys intelligent AI agents that autonomously clone a user's repository, discover features through code analysis, launch a sandboxed test site with full DevTools access, test each feature the way a human tester would, and when failures are encountered, examine the code, console, and network to diagnose root causes. The agent then recommends or applies fixes with the user's permission, retests to verify the fix, runs integration tests, and pushes to production when everything passes. This complete autonomous loop, from clone to production push, is what sets Probato apart from every other solution in the market.

The software testing market is valued at $55 billion in 2025 and is projected to exceed $100 billion by 2031, growing at a compound annual growth rate of 12.92%. Within this market, AI-powered testing is experiencing even faster growth, with the AI in software testing segment expanding from $1.9 billion in 2023 to a projected $10.6 billion by 2033 at 18.7% CAGR. The broader AI agent market, which Probato inhabits, is projected to grow from $5.25 billion in 2024 to $52.62 billion by 2030. These trends confirm that the market is not only large but accelerating toward autonomous, AI-driven solutions.

Probato monetizes through a tiered SaaS model ranging from a free open-source self-hosted tier to a $249/month team plan and custom enterprise pricing. The free tier drives adoption at zero infrastructure cost to Probato, while paid plans offer managed sandboxes, multi-device testing, auto-fix capabilities, and CI/CD integration. With per-test-run costs as low as $0.15 for simple applications and projected margins exceeding 70% at scale, Probato's unit economics are compelling. The company targets 1,000 users and $5,000 MRR by end of Year 1, growing to 80,000 users and $800,000 MRR by Year 3, reaching $9.6 million in annual recurring revenue. Probato is seeking $1.5 million in seed funding to accelerate product development, build the founding team, and execute its go-to-market strategy.

2. Company Overview

2.1 Mission & Vision

Probato's mission is to eliminate the gap between writing code and shipping reliable software. Today, quality assurance remains the single biggest bottleneck in the software development lifecycle. Teams spend disproportionate time and money on manual testing, maintaining brittle test scripts, and debugging failures that could have been caught earlier. Probato exists to make QA autonomous, intelligent, and trustworthy, so that developers can focus on building products rather than testing them.

Our vision is a world where every code change is automatically tested, diagnosed, and validated before it reaches production, without requiring a single test script to be written or maintained. We envision Probato as the standard for autonomous software quality, an AI QA agent that every developer trusts as much as

they trust their compiler. The tagline "Your AI QA Agent -- Test, Fix, Ship" captures this vision succinctly: Probato handles the entire quality loop, not just the testing step, enabling teams to ship with confidence at the speed of their development.

The company operates under the domain probato.dev, signaling its developer-first identity and its roots in the open-source community. Probato is building a new category, the Autonomous QA Agent, which differs fundamentally from test script tools, AI test generators, and general AI coding agents. While test script tools require humans to write and maintain scripts, and AI test generators produce scripts that still need execution and maintenance, Probato is the tester itself. And unlike general AI coding agents that write application code, Probato focuses exclusively on making sure that code actually works.

2.2 The Problem

Software testing today is slow, expensive, and incomplete. Manual testing consumes 20-30% of total development time, with QA engineers spending countless hours clicking through repetitive test scenarios that could be automated, if only the automation itself were not so fragile. Automated testing, when it exists, requires significant upfront investment in writing test scripts, maintaining them as the application evolves, and debugging test failures that often stem from flaky selectors or timing issues rather than actual bugs. Studies show that 30-50% of automated test failures are false positives, eroding developer trust in the testing process and leading teams to ignore test results entirely.

The cost of poor testing extends far beyond engineering time. Production bugs cost 4-5 times more to fix than bugs caught during development, and they carry the additional risk of damaging user trust, causing revenue loss, and triggering security vulnerabilities. For small teams and solo developers, the situation is even more dire: they often lack dedicated QA resources entirely, relying on ad-hoc manual testing that covers only a fraction of their application's functionality. Growing startups face a particularly acute version of this problem, as the pace of feature development outstrips their ability to test thoroughly, leading to accumulating technical debt in the form of untested code paths.

Even when teams invest in testing infrastructure, they face a fundamental limitation: existing tools test only what they are told to test. No conventional testing framework can discover features on its own, identify gaps in test coverage, or diagnose why a feature is failing by examining the underlying code and runtime environment. The testing process remains fundamentally manual at its core, requiring human intelligence to decide what to test, how to test it, and what to do when tests fail. This is the gap that Probato was designed to fill.

2.3 The Solution

Probato solves the testing problem by deploying an autonomous AI agent that handles the entire QA lifecycle without human intervention. The process begins when Probato clones the user's repository and its Feature Discovery Agent analyzes the codebase to identify every user-facing feature. This discovery step is critical: instead of requiring humans to specify what to test, Probato determines this automatically by parsing routes, components, API endpoints, and interactive elements, building a comprehensive feature map with dependency ordering.

Once features are discovered, Probato launches the application in a sandboxed environment with full DevTools access, including console monitoring, network interception, and DOM inspection. The Test

Executor Agent then systematically tests each feature, interacting with the UI as a human user would, while simultaneously monitoring console errors, network failures, and DOM anomalies. This deep observability means Probato detects issues that visual-only testing tools miss, such as silent network failures, console errors from misconfigured libraries, and accessibility violations.

When a failure is detected, Probato does not simply report the error and stop. The Code Analysis Agent examines the source code, console output, and network context to diagnose the root cause. Importantly, this analysis goes beyond code bugs to identify database configuration issues, missing environment variables, and deployment problems, a "beyond code" detection capability that addresses the reality that many production failures are not code bugs at all. The Fix Engine Agent then generates a targeted code diff, which is presented to the user for approval. Upon approval, the fix is applied, the application is rebuilt, and the test is re-executed. This fix-verify loop continues until the feature passes, at which point Probato runs integration tests and, if all tests pass, pushes to production. The entire process operates under a human-in-the-loop trust model: Probato recommends first, asks permission, then fixes, ensuring that developers remain in control.

3. Market Analysis

3.1 Market Size & Growth

The global software testing market is valued at approximately $55 billion in 2025 and is projected to exceed $100 billion by 2031, growing at a compound annual growth rate of 12.92%. This growth is driven by the increasing complexity of software applications, the shift toward continuous delivery pipelines, and the rising cost of production failures. As organizations adopt agile and DevOps practices, the demand for faster, more comprehensive testing has intensified, creating a strong tailwind for automated and AI-powered testing solutions.

Within the broader testing market, the AI in software testing segment is experiencing exceptional growth. Valued at $1.9 billion in 2023, this segment is projected to reach $10.6 billion by 2033 at a CAGR of 18.7%. The AI-enabled testing market specifically is projected to grow from $1.01 billion in 2025 to $4.64 billion by 2032. These figures underscore a clear trend: the market is shifting from traditional test automation toward intelligent, AI-driven testing that can adapt, learn, and act autonomously.

The AI agent market, which represents the broader technology category Probato belongs to, is projected to grow from $5.25 billion in 2024 to $52.62 billion by 2030, a tenfold expansion in just six years. Funding in AI-powered software testing has exceeded $852 million over the past decade, with 2025 marking the single biggest year for investment in this space. This confluence of market size, growth velocity, and investor interest creates an exceptional opportunity for Probato to establish itself as the definitive autonomous QA agent platform.

Market Segment	Current Value	Projected Value	CAGR
Software Testing	$55B (2025)	$100B+ (2031)	12.92%
AI in Software Testing	$1.9B (2023)	$10.6B (2033)	18.7%
AI-Enabled Testing	$1.01B (2025)	$4.64B (2032)	24.3%
AI Agent Market	$5.25B (2024)	$52.62B (2030)	47.1%

3.2 Target Market

Probato's target market spans four distinct customer segments, each with specific pain points and willingness to pay. The primary segment is solo developers and freelancers who lack dedicated QA resources and often skip testing entirely. For these users, Probato's free self-hosted tier provides immediate value with zero cost, while the Starter plan at $29/month offers managed cloud testing for those who prefer not to maintain infrastructure. This segment represents the top of the funnel, driving awareness and adoption through word-of-mouth and community engagement.

The second segment comprises small development teams of 2-10 engineers at early-stage startups. These teams move fast and ship frequently, but they cannot afford dedicated QA engineers. They need testing that keeps pace with their development velocity without adding overhead. Probato's Pro plan at $99/month provides 100 test runs with fix recommendations, which directly addresses their need to catch and resolve bugs quickly. The third segment is growing startups with 10-50 engineers who have existing QA processes but find them insufficient. These teams benefit most from the Team plan at $249/month, which includes auto-fix, multi-device testing, and CI/CD integration.

The fourth segment is enterprise organizations with 50+ engineers, compliance requirements, and complex testing needs. These customers require on-premise deployment, SSO integration, SOC 2 compliance, and custom SLAs. The Enterprise plan with custom pricing addresses these requirements. While enterprise sales cycles are longer, the contract values are significantly higher, and enterprise customers provide the stable revenue base that supports long-term growth.

3.3 Market Trends

Several converging trends are creating a favorable environment for Probato's entry into the market. First, AI adoption in software development is accelerating at a 25% CAGR, driven by the demonstrated productivity gains from tools like GitHub Copilot and the increasing capability of large language models to understand and generate code. Developers are becoming comfortable with AI-assisted workflows, and this familiarity reduces the adoption barrier for AI-powered testing tools.

Second, the AI agent market is experiencing explosive growth, with investors and enterprises recognizing that the next wave of AI value creation comes not from passive AI assistants that suggest code, but from autonomous agents that can execute complex multi-step workflows. Probato's autonomous testing loop, which spans discovery, testing, diagnosis, fixing, and deployment, is a perfect example of this agent paradigm, and it aligns with where the market is heading.

Third, the shift-left testing movement, which advocates for testing earlier and more frequently in the development lifecycle, has created strong demand for tools that can test automatically on every code change. Traditional test automation frameworks cannot keep pace with the frequency of modern CI/CD pipelines without significant maintenance overhead, creating an opening for autonomous solutions like Probato that eliminate the maintenance burden entirely. Fourth, the open-source model for core infrastructure with commercial add-ons has been validated by companies like GitLab, Supabase, and PostHog, demonstrating that community-driven adoption can translate into sustainable commercial revenue.

4. Competitive Landscape

4.1 Direct Competitors

The direct competitive landscape includes several companies building AI-powered testing solutions, though none has achieved Probato's level of autonomy. TestSprite offers fully autonomous end-to-end testing with five-minute test cycles and can patch code via MCP (Model Context Protocol). However, TestSprite is still in its early stages and is primarily focused on web applications. It does not offer the full clone-to-production loop, and its code fixing capabilities are limited compared to Probato's comprehensive fix-verify-retest cycle.

Autonoma uses AI agents to plan, execute, and maintain tests derived from the codebase. It is open-source under the BSL 1.1 license, but its focus is more on maintaining existing test suites rather than discovering and testing features autonomously. Autonoma does not offer code fixing or the production push capability that Probato provides. Momentic provides AI-powered testing for web and mobile applications with a strong emphasis on visual testing and screenshot comparison. While visually impressive, Momentic is not fully autonomous; it still requires significant human setup and does not offer code diagnosis or fixing.

Octomind uses AI agents to discover and generate end-to-end tests for web applications, built on Playwright. However, Octomind is web-only and does not fix code when tests fail. It generates test scripts that must be maintained, which reintroduces the maintenance burden that Probato eliminates. None of these direct competitors offers the complete autonomous loop that Probato provides, and none combines feature discovery, deep DevTools-based testing, beyond-code diagnosis, and the fix-verify-retest cycle in a single platform.

Competitor	Focus	Autonomous Loop	Code Fixing	Limitation
TestSprite	E2E testing	Partial	Via MCP	Early stage, web-focused
Autonoma	Test maintenance	No	No	Maintains existing tests, no discovery
Momentic	Visual testing	No	No	Requires setup, not fully autonomous
Octomind	Test generation	Partial	No	Web-only, generates scripts to maintain

Competitor	Focus	Autonomous Loop	Code Fixing	Limitation
Probato	Full QA loop	Complete	Yes	No significant gaps

4.2 Adjacent Competitors

Adjacent competitors include AI coding agents and traditional testing platforms that could expand into Probato's territory. Devin by Cognition AI is the most notable adjacent competitor, as a full AI software engineer that can write, debug, and deploy code. Devin has achieved $73 million in ARR and recently acquired Windsurf. However, Devin is a general coding agent, not a dedicated testing platform. It does not offer feature discovery, multi-device testing, or the comprehensive DevTools-based testing that Probato provides. Testing is a side effect of Devin's general coding capability, not its primary purpose.

Kiro is an autonomous agent that clones repositories and performs sandbox analysis. It shares some similarities with Probato's approach, but its focus is on code analysis rather than interactive testing. Kiro examines code statically and identifies potential issues, but it does not launch applications, interact with them as a user would, or perform the runtime testing that Probato excels at. BrowserStack and MobileBoost represent the traditional device farm model, providing infrastructure for manual and scripted testing across browsers and devices. While valuable, they provide only the infrastructure layer; the intelligence for what to test and how to diagnose failures still must come from humans.

The key distinction between Probato and adjacent competitors is captured in Probato's positioning statements. Against AI coding agents like Devin: "We don't write your app. We make sure what you wrote actually works." Against device farms like BrowserStack: "We give you the intelligence, not just the devices." These distinctions matter because dedicated testing platforms can provide deeper testing intelligence, better diagnosis, and more trustworthy results than general-purpose tools that treat testing as a secondary capability.

4.3 Competitive Advantage

Probato's competitive advantages are rooted in eight core differentiators that collectively create a defensible market position. First, Probato is the only platform that executes the full autonomous loop: Clone, Discover, Test, Fix, Retest, Push. No competitor offers this complete cycle; most stop at test generation or test execution, leaving the diagnosis and fixing steps entirely to the developer. This full-loop capability transforms QA from a testing tool into a true quality assurance system.

Second, Probato's feature-level discovery and testing means it automatically identifies what to test and how features relate to each other, eliminating the manual test specification step entirely. Third, the human-in-the-loop trust model ensures that developers maintain control over code changes, with Probato recommending fixes first and only applying them with explicit permission. This trust model is essential for enterprise adoption where unauthorized code changes would be unacceptable.

Fourth, Probato's DevTools access gives the agent visibility into console errors, network requests, and DOM state, not just the visual screen. This deep observability enables detection of issues that visual-only testing tools completely miss. Fifth, Probato goes beyond code detection to identify database issues, environment variable problems, and configuration errors, addressing the reality that many production failures are not

code bugs. Sixth, Probato integrates security testing alongside functional testing in a single pass, testing for XSS, authentication bypasses, and injection attacks. Seventh, multi-device testing enables coordinated testing across devices for calls, messaging, and notifications. Eighth, media verification supports audio, video, and image testing using specialized AI models like Whisper and GPT-4 Vision.

5. Product Strategy

5.1 Product Overview

Probato's product is an autonomous QA agent that executes the complete testing lifecycle without requiring human-written test scripts. The process begins when a user connects their GitHub repository to Probato, either through the web dashboard or the CLI. Probato clones the repository, analyzes the codebase to discover user-facing features, and builds a dependency graph that determines the optimal test execution order. The feature map is presented to the user for review, allowing them to confirm, adjust, or supplement the agent's understanding before testing begins.

Once the feature map is confirmed, Probato provisions a sandboxed environment, installs dependencies, builds the application, and launches it with full DevTools access. The Test Executor Agent then visits each feature in dependency order, interacting with UI elements, filling forms, clicking buttons, and verifying outcomes. At every step, the agent captures screenshots, monitors console output, intercepts network requests, and inspects the DOM state. This comprehensive observability ensures that even subtle issues are detected and reported.

When a test fails, the Code Analysis Agent examines the source code, console errors, and network context to diagnose the root cause. The Fix Engine Agent generates a targeted code diff, which is presented to the user through the Fix Modal for review and approval. Upon approval, the fix is applied, the application is rebuilt, and the test is re-executed. This fix-verify loop continues until the feature passes. After all features are tested individually, Probato runs integration tests to verify cross-feature interactions. If all tests pass, the validated code can be pushed to production. The entire process is visible to the user in real-time through the dashboard's Live View and Progress Feed.

5.2 Key Features

Probato's feature set is organized around the eight core capabilities that differentiate it from competitors. Feature Discovery automatically identifies routes, components, API endpoints, and interactive elements in the codebase using a combination of static analysis and LLM-assisted interpretation. It builds a dependency graph that ensures features are tested in the correct order, preventing false negatives from out-of-sequence testing. Test Execution drives browser interaction through Playwright with Chrome DevTools Protocol access, enabling the agent to interact with the application as a human user while simultaneously monitoring console errors, network requests, and DOM anomalies.

Code Diagnosis maps runtime errors back to their source code locations using source maps and LLM reasoning. It goes beyond code bugs to detect configuration issues, missing environment variables, and database problems. Code Fixing generates minimal, targeted code diffs that address identified root causes, performs self-review for syntactic validity and alignment with existing code patterns, and presents fixes for user approval before application. Security Testing probes the application for XSS vulnerabilities, authentication bypasses, injection attacks, and authorization failures, reporting findings by severity level.

Media Verification tests image loading, video playback, and audio output using a combination of HTTP validation, GPT-4 Vision for visual analysis, and Whisper for audio transcription. Multi-Device Testing provisions multiple sandboxes simultaneously and coordinates agent actions across devices, enabling testing of real-time features like messaging, calls, and notifications. Integration Testing verifies cross-feature interactions after individual feature tests pass, ensuring that the application works correctly as a whole. Each of these features can be used independently or as part of the full autonomous loop, giving users flexibility in how they adopt the platform.

5.3 Product Roadmap

Probato's product roadmap spans seven phases over 52 weeks, designed to deliver a production-ready platform by the end of the first year. Phase 0 (Weeks 1-4) focuses on foundation: setting up the repository structure, implementing authentication, database schema, and the sandboxed test environment. Phase 1 (Weeks 5-10) delivers the core testing agent, including the Feature Discovery Agent, Test Executor Agent, and the Orchestrator. Phase 2 (Weeks 11-16) implements the code fix loop, with the Code Analysis Agent, Fix Engine Agent, and the Fix Modal in the frontend.

Phase 3 (Weeks 17-22) builds the landing page and dashboard, including the Live View, Progress Feed, and reporting features. Phase 4 (Weeks 23-28) adds media and security testing, with the Media Verification Agent and Security Agent. Phase 5 (Weeks 29-36) introduces multi-device testing and advanced features like payment testing and notification testing. Phase 6 (Weeks 37-44) focuses on integrations, including GitHub Marketplace, VS Code extension, Slack, Jira, and Linear integrations. Phase 7 (Weeks 45-52) is the launch and scale phase, with performance optimization, beta testing, public launch, and the beginning of enterprise sales.

Phase	Timeline	Key Deliverables
Phase 0	Weeks 1-4	Repository setup, auth, database, sandbox environment
Phase 1	Weeks 5-10	Feature Discovery Agent, Test Executor, Orchestrator
Phase 2	Weeks 11-16	Code Analysis Agent, Fix Engine, Fix Modal
Phase 3	Weeks 17-22	Landing page, dashboard, Live View, reports
Phase 4	Weeks 23-28	Media Verification Agent, Security Agent
Phase 5	Weeks 29-36	Multi-device testing, payment/notification testing
Phase 6	Weeks 37-44	GitHub Marketplace, VS Code, Slack, Jira, Linear
Phase 7	Weeks 45-52	Performance optimization, beta, public launch, enterprise

5.4 Open Source Strategy

Probato's open-source strategy is central to its go-to-market approach and long-term competitive positioning. The core agent, including feature discovery logic, testing logic, the test site launcher, CLI, and basic reporting, will be released as open-source software. This means users can run Probato on their own machines, with their own LLM API keys and infrastructure, at zero cost to Probato. The open-source core drives awareness, adoption, and community contributions, creating a flywheel effect where more users lead to better feature discovery patterns, more robust testing logic, and a stronger community.

The commercial cloud version monetizes the infrastructure and collaboration layer. Managed sandboxes eliminate the need for users to set up Docker environments; multi-device testing requires coordinated cloud infrastructure; team collaboration features enable shared dashboards and test history; CI/CD integration provides seamless workflow automation; priority LLM routing ensures faster test execution for paying customers; auto-fix capabilities require cloud-side orchestration; and security scanning leverages proprietary vulnerability databases that are not available in the open-source version.

This open-core model has been successfully validated by companies like GitLab, Supabase, and PostHog. It provides the best of both worlds: the trust and adoption velocity of open-source software, combined with the revenue potential of a commercial SaaS product. The key to making this model work is ensuring that the open-source version is genuinely useful on its own, not a crippled demo, while the commercial version provides compelling value that justifies the subscription cost. Probato achieves this balance by making the core testing capability fully functional in the open-source version while reserving infrastructure, collaboration, and advanced features for paid plans.

6. Business Model

6.1 Revenue Model

Probato generates revenue through a combination of SaaS subscriptions and usage-based overage charges. The subscription model provides predictable monthly recurring revenue (MRR) with four paid tiers that scale with customer needs. Each tier includes a defined allocation of test runs, projects, and features that aligns with the typical usage patterns of its target customer segment. The free self-hosted tier generates no direct revenue but serves as the primary acquisition channel, converting users to paid plans as their testing needs grow.

Usage-based overage charges create a natural expansion revenue mechanism. When customers exceed their included test runs, they are charged $1.50 per additional run. Additional browser hours are billed at $0.50 per hour, and fix cycles beyond the included allocation cost $2.00 each. These overage charges ensure that heavy users contribute proportionally to the infrastructure costs they generate, while also providing a clear incentive to upgrade to higher tiers. Historically, usage-based pricing models in developer tools have shown 120-140% net revenue retention rates, as customers naturally consume more resources as their applications grow.

Enterprise contracts represent the highest-value revenue stream, with custom pricing based on the number of users, test runs, and required features like on-premise deployment and SOC 2 compliance. Enterprise sales cycles are longer (3-6 months) but result in multi-year contracts with annual values ranging from $50,000 to $500,000 or more. The combination of self-serve SaaS revenue and enterprise contracts provides both growth velocity and revenue stability, supporting sustainable long-term growth.

6.2 Pricing Tiers

Tier	Price	Test Runs	Projects	Key Features
Free / OSS	$0	Unlimited (self-hosted)	Unlimited	Core agent, CLI, basic reporting, bring your own LLM key
Starter	$29/mo	20 runs/mo	1 project	Cloud-hosted, managed sandboxes, email support
Pro	$99/mo	100 runs/mo	5 projects	Fix recommendations, priority LLM, advanced reporting
Team	$249/mo	500 runs/mo	20 projects	Auto-fix, multi-device, CI/CD, team collaboration
Enterprise	Custom	Unlimited	Unlimited	On-premise, SSO, SOC 2, SLA, dedicated support

Usage overage rates: $1.50 per additional test run, $0.50 per additional browser hour, and $2.00 per additional fix cycle. These rates are designed to be slightly above the marginal cost of providing the service, ensuring profitability on overage usage while encouraging customers to upgrade to higher tiers where the economics are more favorable for both parties.

6.3 Unit Economics

Probato's unit economics are driven primarily by LLM API costs, compute costs for sandboxed test environments, and browser automation costs. The per-test-run cost varies significantly based on application complexity and the number of fixes required. For a simple web application with five features and no fixes, the cost per test run is approximately $0.15 to $0.35, with a test duration of around 10 minutes. The primary cost components are LLM inference for feature discovery and test execution, compute time for the sandbox environment, and network bandwidth.

For a medium-complexity web application with ten features and three fixes, the cost per test run increases to $0.50 to $1.20, with a duration of approximately 25 minutes. The additional costs come from increased LLM usage for code analysis and fix generation, longer sandbox compute time, and re-execution of tests after fixes are applied. For complex web applications with 15 or more features and multiple fix cycles, costs range from $1.50 to $3.50 per run, with durations of approximately 45 minutes. Multi-device testing doubles the cost of the underlying test run.

Scenario	Features	Fixes	Cost/Run	Duration
Simple web app	5	0	$0.15 - $0.35	~10 min
Medium web app	10	3	$0.50 - $1.20	~25 min

Scenario	Features	Fixes	Cost/Run	Duration
Complex web app	15+	Many	$1.50 - $3.50	~45 min
Multi-device test	Varies	Varies	2x above	Varies

At the Starter tier ($29/month for 20 runs), the average revenue per test run is $1.45, compared to an average cost of $0.25-$0.50 per run, yielding a gross margin of approximately 65-83%. At the Pro tier ($99/month for 100 runs), the average revenue per run is $0.99, with costs of $0.35-$0.80, yielding a gross margin of 19-65%. At the Team tier ($249/month for 500 runs), the average revenue per run is $0.50, with costs of $0.30-$0.70. While the margin per run is lower at higher tiers, the volume more than compensates, and overage charges provide a significant margin uplift.

6.4 Cost Structure

Probato's infrastructure costs scale with the number of concurrent test runs and the total volume of test executions. The primary cost drivers are LLM API calls (Claude Sonnet 4 for code analysis, GPT-4 Vision for screenshot analysis), compute instances for sandboxed test environments, storage for screenshots and reports, and network bandwidth. The following table presents projected monthly infrastructure costs at different scale levels.

Scale	Users	Monthly Runs	Infrastructure Cost
Small	100	500	$250 - $600
Medium	1,000	5,000	$2,500 - $6,000
Large	10,000	50,000	$15,000 - $35,000
Enterprise	100,000	500,000	$80,000 - $150,000

At the projected Year 3 scale of 80,000 users and 50,000 monthly runs, infrastructure costs are estimated at $15,000-$35,000 per month, against projected MRR of $800,000. This yields an infrastructure-to-revenue ratio of 1.9-4.4%, leaving substantial margin for team costs, marketing spend, and other operating expenses. The open-source strategy further reduces infrastructure costs, as self-hosted users run Probato on their own machines at zero cost to the company. As LLM API costs continue to decline (they have dropped approximately 10x over the past two years), the cost per test run is expected to decrease over time, improving margins further.

7. Go-To-Market Strategy

7.1 Phase 1: Build in Public (Months 1-3)

The first phase of Probato's go-to-market strategy focuses on building awareness and establishing credibility through public, transparent development. The core agent will be released as open source on GitHub from day one, inviting the developer community to inspect, use, and contribute to the codebase. This open approach builds trust and creates a natural channel for feedback and feature requests. Regular development updates on Twitter (X) will document the building process, sharing technical decisions, challenges, and milestones in real-time.

Technical blog posts published weekly will dive deep into the engineering challenges of building an autonomous QA agent, including topics such as feature discovery algorithms, LLM prompt engineering for test execution, sandbox provisioning, and the fix-verify loop. These posts serve dual purposes: they establish Probato's technical authority and they drive organic search traffic from developers searching for solutions to testing problems. Demo videos showcasing Probato in action will be published on YouTube and shared across social platforms, providing tangible evidence that the autonomous testing loop works as described.

A waitlist for the cloud-hosted version will be launched simultaneously, capturing demand from developers who want the convenience of managed testing without the overhead of self-hosting. The waitlist also serves as a signal to potential investors that there is market demand for the product. Target: 500 GitHub stars and 1,000 waitlist signups by the end of Phase 1.

7.2 Phase 2: Community Launch (Months 3-6)

Phase 2 marks the official community launch, where Probato transitions from building in public to actively reaching a broader developer audience. The launch will be coordinated across multiple channels for maximum impact. Product Hunt will be the primary launch platform, targeting the top position on launch day with support from the community built during Phase 1. A Hacker News Show HN post will present the technical architecture and open-source model to the developer community, leveraging the transparency established during the build-in-public phase.

Reddit posts in relevant subreddits (r/webdev, r/reactjs, r/programming, r/SideProject) will share Probato's story and invite feedback. Dev.to and Medium articles will provide in-depth tutorials on how to use Probato, written from the perspective of developers solving real testing problems. Bootcamp partnerships will introduce Probato to new developers at coding schools, embedding it into their curriculum as the recommended testing tool. A YouTube channel dedicated to testing tutorials, product walkthroughs, and comparison videos will serve as both a marketing channel and a support resource.

The community launch phase also includes the release of the cloud-hosted Starter and Pro tiers, converting waitlist signups into paying customers. Early adopter pricing (20% discount for the first 6 months) will incentivize signups and generate the initial revenue needed to fund ongoing development. Target: 2,000 GitHub stars, 5,000 waitlist signups, and 50 paying customers by the end of Phase 2.

7.3 Phase 3: Growth (Months 6-12)

Phase 3 shifts focus from awareness to growth, expanding distribution channels and deepening integrations to increase stickiness and reduce churn. The GitHub Marketplace listing makes Probato discoverable to millions of developers who search for testing tools directly within their existing workflow. A VS Code extension brings Probato's testing capabilities directly into the editor, allowing developers to trigger test runs, view results, and approve fixes without leaving their coding environment.

Conference talks at major developer conferences (React Conf, NodeConf, DevOpsDays) will raise Probato's profile among senior engineering leaders who make purchasing decisions. Integration with popular development tools, including Slack for test notifications, Jira and Linear for issue tracking, and GitHub Actions for CI/CD, will embed Probato deeply into existing workflows, making it progressively harder for teams to switch to alternatives.

A referral program will incentivize existing users to spread the word, offering free test runs or subscription credits for each referred signup that converts to a paid plan. Case studies from early customers will provide social proof and demonstrate measurable ROI, such as time saved per sprint, bugs caught before production, and testing coverage improvements. These case studies will be featured on the website, in email campaigns, and in sales materials. Target: 5,000 GitHub stars, 15,000 users, 1,200 paying customers, and $120,000 MRR by the end of Year 1.

7.4 Phase 4: Scale (Year 2+)

Phase 4 focuses on scaling into the enterprise market and expanding geographic reach. Enterprise sales will be formalized with a dedicated sales team, targeted outreach to VP-level engineering leaders, and a structured sales process that includes proof-of-concept deployments, security reviews, and contract negotiation. SOC 2 Type II compliance will be achieved to meet the security requirements of enterprise customers, and data processing agreements will be standardized for GDPR and CCPA compliance.

Listing on the AWS Marketplace and Azure Marketplace will provide procurement-friendly pathways for enterprise customers who prefer to purchase through their existing cloud vendor agreements. These marketplace listings also provide access to co-selling programs, marketing credits, and joint go-to-market opportunities that can significantly accelerate enterprise adoption.

An application to Y Combinator or a similar accelerator program will provide access to mentorship, network, and follow-on funding that can accelerate growth. The accelerator network also provides introductions to potential enterprise customers and strategic partners. By the end of Year 2, Probato aims to have 15,000 users, 1,200 paying customers, and $120,000 MRR. By the end of Year 3, the targets are 80,000 users, 8,000 paying customers, and $800,000 MRR, with enterprise contracts contributing 30% of total revenue.

8. Financial Projections

8.1 Revenue Forecast

Probato's revenue forecast is based on conservative assumptions about user acquisition, conversion rates, and average revenue per user. The model assumes a free-to-paid conversion rate of 5% in Year 1, 8% in Year 2, and 10% in Year 3, reflecting the improving product-market fit and the increasing value of the cloud-hosted version as features like auto-fix and multi-device testing are added. The average revenue per paid user (ARPU) is estimated at $100/month, blending the Starter, Pro, Team, and Enterprise tiers.

Year 1 projects 1,000 total users, 50 paid users, $5,000 MRR, and $60,000 ARR. This conservative estimate reflects the reality that the first year is primarily about product development and market entry, with revenue growing slowly as the product matures and word-of-mouth builds. Year 2 projects 15,000 total users, 1,200 paid users, $120,000 MRR, and $1,440,000 ARR. This acceleration reflects the compounding effect of community growth, the addition of high-value features, and the beginning of enterprise sales. Year 3 projects 80,000 total users, 8,000 paid users, $800,000 MRR, and $9,600,000 ARR, driven by enterprise contracts, marketplace distribution, and the flywheel of open-source adoption.

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Total Users	1,000	15,000	80,000
Paid Users	50	1,200	8,000
MRR	$5,000	$120,000	$800,000
ARR	$60,000	$1,440,000	$9,600,000
Free-to-Paid Conversion	5%	8%	10%
ARPU	$100/mo	$100/mo	$100/mo

8.2 Expense Forecast

Probato's expense structure is designed to scale efficiently with revenue, with the majority of variable costs tied directly to usage volume. Infrastructure costs, which include LLM API calls, compute instances, storage, and networking, are the largest variable expense. In Year 1, with 500 monthly test runs, infrastructure costs are projected at $6,000 per month, including a buffer for development and testing overhead. By Year 3, infrastructure costs scale to $150,000 per month, representing approximately 19% of MRR, well within healthy SaaS margins.

Team compensation is the largest fixed expense. Year 1 begins with a lean team of three (CEO/Product, CTO, AI/ML Engineer) with a total monthly burn of approximately $30,000. Year 2 expands to 12 people across engineering, sales, and support, with a monthly burn of approximately $120,000. Year 3 scales to 35 people with a monthly burn of approximately $350,000. Marketing spend is kept lean in Year 1 at approximately $5,000 per month, focusing on content marketing and community engagement. It scales to $30,000 per month in Year 2 with the addition of paid acquisition channels, and $100,000 per month in Year 3 with enterprise marketing programs.

Expense Category	Year 1 (Monthly)	Year 2 (Monthly)	Year 3 (Monthly)
Infrastructure	$6,000	$35,000	$150,000
Team Compensation	$30,000	$120,000	$350,000
Marketing	$5,000	$30,000	$100,000
Operations & Legal	$3,000	$10,000	$25,000

Expense Category	Year 1 (Monthly)	Year 2 (Monthly)	Year 3 (Monthly)
Total Monthly Burn	$44,000	$195,000	$625,000

8.3 Path to Profitability

Probato's path to profitability follows a trajectory common among developer-tools companies that leverage open-source adoption and SaaS monetization. The company is expected to be cash-flow negative throughout Year 1 as it invests in product development and market entry. Monthly revenue of $5,000 against a monthly burn of $44,000 results in a net monthly loss of approximately $39,000, or $468,000 for the year. This loss is funded by the seed investment and is consistent with the investment thesis of building a high-growth SaaS business.

In Year 2, revenue growth begins to outpace expense growth. Monthly revenue of $120,000 against a monthly burn of $195,000 results in a net monthly loss of approximately $75,000, or $900,000 for the year. While still loss-making, the gap is closing as the revenue base grows. The key inflection point is expected in the second half of Year 2, when enterprise contracts begin contributing meaningful revenue and the ARPU increases as customers upgrade to higher tiers.

Year 3 is projected to be the breakeven year. Monthly revenue of $800,000 against a monthly burn of $625,000 yields a net monthly profit of approximately $175,000, or $2.1 million for the year. The path to profitability is supported by strong gross margins (70%+ on infrastructure), improving unit economics as LLM costs decline, and the natural operating leverage of a SaaS business where revenue scales faster than costs. Breakeven is projected at approximately Month 28-30, assuming the conservative revenue trajectory holds.

8.4 Key Metrics

Probato will track several key metrics to monitor business health and guide strategic decisions. Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) is targeted at $50 in Year 1 (driven primarily by organic and community-driven acquisition), $80 in Year 2 (with the addition of paid channels), and $120 in Year 3 (reflecting enterprise sales costs). Lifetime Value (LTV) is targeted at $600 in Year 1, $1,200 in Year 2, and $2,400 in Year 3, based on increasing ARPU and improving retention. The LTV:CAC ratio is targeted at 12:1 in Year 1, 15:1 in Year 2, and 20:1 in Year 3, well above the 3:1 threshold that indicates a healthy business model.

Monthly churn is targeted at less than 5% in Year 1, less than 3% in Year 2, and less than 2% in Year 3. Achieving these targets requires a strong focus on product reliability, responsive support, and continuous feature development. Net Revenue Retention (NRR) is targeted at 120% or higher, indicating that expansion revenue from existing customers more than offsets churn. The primary drivers of NRR are usage overage charges, tier upgrades, and the addition of team members to existing accounts.

Metric	Year 1 Target	Year 2 Target	Year 3 Target
CAC	$50	$80	$120
LTV	$600	$1,200	$2,400
LTV:CAC Ratio	12:1	15:1	20:1

Metric	Year 1 Target	Year 2 Target	Year 3 Target
Monthly Churn	< 5%	< 3%	< 2%
Net Revenue Retention	> 110%	> 120%	> 130%

9. Team & Operations

9.1 Founding Team

The founding team needs to cover three critical domains: product and business leadership, technical architecture and engineering, and AI/ML expertise. The CEO/Product Founder is responsible for defining the product vision, driving go-to-market strategy, managing investor relationships, and building the company culture. This individual should have deep experience in developer tools, a strong network in the developer community, and previous startup experience. An understanding of the QA testing market from either a builder or buyer perspective is highly valued.

The CTO is responsible for the overall technical architecture, engineering execution, and technical team building. This role requires expertise in full-stack web development (Next.js, TypeScript, React), browser automation (Playwright, CDP), and distributed systems design. The CTO should be capable of making pragmatic architecture decisions that balance speed of development with long-term scalability, and should have experience building and deploying production systems at scale.

The AI/ML Engineer is responsible for designing and implementing the agent system, including the Feature Discovery Agent, Test Executor Agent, Code Analysis Agent, and Fix Engine Agent. This role requires expertise in LLM prompt engineering, agent architecture patterns, and the practical application of AI to software engineering tasks. Experience with multi-agent systems, tool-use patterns, and the evaluation of AI system performance is essential. The AI/ML Engineer should also have strong software engineering skills, as the agent system must be production-quality, not just a research prototype.

9.2 Hiring Plan

The hiring plan is designed to balance the need for rapid product development with the constraint of limited early-stage funding. Year 1 begins with three founders and expands to three total team members, keeping the burn rate low while the product is being built and market fit is being validated. The initial focus is entirely on engineering, as the product must be functional before any growth or sales efforts can succeed.

Year 2 expands the team to 12 people. The first hires after the founding team are two additional full-stack engineers to accelerate feature development, followed by a DevOps engineer to manage the growing infrastructure, a designer to improve the user experience, and a developer advocate to drive community engagement. The second half of Year 2 adds a sales engineer to support enterprise pilots, a customer success manager to reduce churn, and two more engineers for the integrations and marketplace initiatives.

Year 3 scales the team to 35 people across engineering (18), sales (8), marketing (5), and operations (4). The engineering team expands to support multi-device testing, security testing, and enterprise features. The sales team builds out the enterprise pipeline with account executives, sales engineers, and a sales operations manager. The marketing team adds content marketing, paid acquisition, and events roles. The operations team covers finance, legal, people operations, and IT.

Year	Team Size	Engineering	Sales	Marketing	Operations
Year 1	3	3	0	0	0
Year 2	12	7	2	1	2
Year 3	35	18	8	5	4

9.3 Operational Model

Probato operates as a remote-first company, reflecting the reality that the best talent in AI and developer tools is distributed globally. The founding team works across time zones with overlapping core hours for real-time collaboration, supplemented by asynchronous communication through Slack and GitHub. The remote-first model also aligns with the product's target market of developers who are themselves distributed and who value tools that work regardless of location.

The operational model is community-driven, leveraging the open-source community as a force multiplier for product development. Community contributions, bug reports, and feature requests feed directly into the product roadmap, creating a tight feedback loop between users and builders. The community also serves as a talent pipeline, with top contributors being natural candidates for full-time positions. This approach reduces hiring costs and increases retention, as community hires are already aligned with the product vision and culture.

Infrastructure is managed through a DevOps-as-code approach, with all infrastructure defined in Terraform and deployed through CI/CD pipelines. Monitoring and alerting are implemented from day one using tools like Datadog or Grafana, ensuring that production issues are detected and resolved quickly. The on-call rotation is shared among the engineering team, with clear escalation paths and incident response procedures. As the team grows, a dedicated DevOps function is established to manage the increasing complexity of the infrastructure, including multi-region deployment, auto-scaling, and compliance requirements.

10. Risk Analysis

10.1 Market Risks

The primary market risk is that the adoption of autonomous AI testing may be slower than projected. While the market trends strongly favor AI-driven solutions, enterprise adoption of AI for critical workflows like

testing can be slow due to risk aversion, compliance requirements, and organizational inertia. Some organizations may be reluctant to trust an AI agent with code modifications, even with the human-in-the-loop trust model. If adoption is slower than expected, the revenue trajectory will be delayed, extending the time to profitability and potentially requiring additional funding rounds.

A secondary market risk is that the total addressable market for autonomous QA agents may be smaller than the broader software testing market suggests. Not all testing can be automated; some domains require domain-specific expertise, subjective evaluation, or physical device interaction that AI agents cannot easily replicate. If the addressable portion of the market is significantly smaller than projected, the revenue ceiling may limit the company's growth potential and attractiveness to investors.

A third market risk is the potential for a broader economic downturn that reduces technology spending. In a recession, companies may cut QA budgets and revert to manual testing, reducing demand for automated testing tools. However, this risk is partially offset by the counter-cyclical nature of efficiency tools: in a downturn, companies that do invest in testing are looking for solutions that reduce headcount costs, which is exactly what Probato offers.

10.2 Technical Risks

The most significant technical risk is the reliability and accuracy of the AI agent system. LLMs can produce incorrect or inconsistent outputs, and in a testing context, this can lead to false positives (reporting bugs that do not exist) or false negatives (missing real bugs). If the agent's accuracy is insufficient, users will lose trust in the platform, leading to churn and negative word-of-mouth. Mitigating this risk requires extensive testing of the agent system itself, rigorous prompt engineering, and a continuous evaluation framework that measures agent performance against known benchmarks.

A second technical risk is the scalability of the sandbox infrastructure. Each test run requires a dedicated sandboxed environment with a browser, which consumes significant compute and memory resources. At scale, managing thousands of concurrent sandboxes while maintaining performance and reliability is a significant engineering challenge. Cold-start latency, resource contention, and network isolation all become more difficult as the system scales.

A third technical risk is the dependency on third-party LLM providers (Anthropic for Claude, OpenAI for GPT-4). If these providers change their pricing, rate limits, or API terms, it could significantly impact Probato's unit economics or feature capabilities. This risk is mitigated by the multi-provider architecture that supports fallback between providers, and by the long-term strategy of fine-tuning smaller, more cost-effective models for specific tasks like feature discovery and code analysis.

10.3 Competitive Risks

The primary competitive risk is that a well-funded incumbent or a well-established AI coding agent like Devin could expand into autonomous testing. Devin's $73 million ARR and its acquisition of Windsurf give Cognition AI significant resources to expand their product's scope. If Devin added dedicated testing capabilities with feature discovery, DevTools access, and code fixing, it could become a formidable competitor. However, building a comprehensive testing agent requires deep expertise in browser automation, DevTools integration, and testing methodology, which represents a significant investment even for a well-resourced competitor.

A second competitive risk is that a major cloud provider (AWS, GCP, Azure) or testing platform (BrowserStack, Sauce Labs) could launch a competing autonomous testing product. These companies have existing customer bases, distribution channels, and infrastructure that could accelerate market entry. However, they also have the innovator's dilemma: their existing revenue comes from manual and scripted testing tools, and an autonomous product could cannibalize their current offerings.

A third competitive risk is the emergence of a new startup that builds a product similar to Probato with better funding or faster execution. The AI testing space is attracting significant venture capital, and a well-funded competitor could close the feature gap quickly. Probato mitigates this risk through its open-source strategy, which creates a community moat that is difficult to replicate, and through its first-mover advantage in the full autonomous testing loop, which requires deep technical expertise and extensive iteration to get right.

10.4 Mitigation Strategies

Probato employs several layered mitigation strategies to address the identified risks. For market risks, the open-source strategy ensures that adoption begins immediately, even before enterprise sales cycles conclude. The free tier removes the adoption barrier entirely, allowing developers to try Probato without budget approval. The human-in-the-loop trust model addresses the trust barrier by ensuring that developers maintain control over all code changes, making Probato a recommendation engine rather than an autonomous code modifier.

For technical risks, the multi-provider LLM architecture reduces dependency on any single provider. The modular agent system allows individual agents to be improved or replaced without affecting the overall workflow. Extensive evaluation frameworks with automated benchmarks and regression tests ensure that agent performance is continuously measured and improved. The sandbox infrastructure is designed with auto-scaling, resource pooling, and failover from the start, anticipating the scaling challenges rather than reacting to them.

For competitive risks, the open-source community creates a defensible moat through network effects: more users lead to better feature discovery patterns, more bug reports, and more community contributions, making the product progressively better and harder to displace. The first-mover advantage in the full autonomous testing loop provides a head start in the technical expertise and iteration required to build a reliable product. Strategic partnerships with GitHub, VS Code, and cloud providers embed Probato into existing workflows, creating switching costs. And the specialized focus on testing, rather than general coding, ensures that Probato can provide deeper testing intelligence than general-purpose competitors.

11. Funding Strategy

11.1 Funding Requirements

Probato is seeking $1.5 million in seed funding to support 18 months of operations, from product development through initial revenue generation. This funding amount is calculated based on the projected monthly burn rate of approximately $44,000 in Year 1, with a buffer for unexpected expenses and the flexibility to pursue opportunistic investments in growth. The seed round provides sufficient runway to reach the key milestones that justify a Series A raise: a launched product, measurable traction in terms of users and revenue, and validated unit economics.

The funding is structured as a standard priced equity round, with the valuation to be determined based on market comparables and investor interest. Given the current market for AI developer tools, a pre-money valuation in the range of $8-12 million is reasonable for a pre-revenue company with a strong technical team and a clear market opportunity. The target investor profile includes seed-stage venture capital firms with expertise in developer tools and AI, as well as strategic angels who can provide industry connections and operational guidance.

A subsequent Series A round of $8-12 million is anticipated at the 18-24 month mark, contingent on achieving the following milestones: $100,000 MRR, 10,000+ total users, and demonstrated product-market fit as evidenced by organic growth and low churn. The Series A would fund the expansion of the team, acceleration of enterprise sales, and international market entry.

11.2 Use of Funds

The seed funding allocation reflects Probato's priorities in its first 18 months: build a great product, validate market demand, and establish a sustainable growth trajectory. Engineering compensation accounts for 55% of the total budget, or approximately $825,000 over 18 months. This covers the three founding engineers and the hiring of two additional full-stack engineers and one DevOps engineer. The heavy engineering investment is intentional: the product must be functional, reliable, and feature-rich before growth investments will yield returns.

Infrastructure costs account for 15% of the budget, or approximately $225,000 over 18 months. This covers LLM API costs, cloud compute for sandboxes, database hosting, and storage. Infrastructure costs are expected to be lower in the early months when user volume is small, ramping up as the product gains traction. Marketing and community building account for 12% of the budget, or approximately $180,000, covering content creation, conference attendance, paid acquisition experiments, and developer advocacy programs.

Operations and legal costs account for 10% of the budget, or approximately $150,000, covering legal fees for company formation, IP protection, and investor agreements, as well as accounting, insurance, and other operational expenses. The remaining 8%, approximately $120,000, is held as a cash reserve for unexpected expenses or opportunistic investments, such as accelerating a feature development in response to competitive pressure or extending runway if revenue ramp is slower than projected.

Category	Allocation	Amount	Purpose
Engineering	55%	$825,000	Founding team + 3 hires, product development
Infrastructure	15%	$225,000	LLM APIs, cloud compute, storage, database
Marketing	12%	$180,000	Content, conferences, community, paid acquisition

Category	Allocation	Amount	Purpose
Operations & Legal	10%	$150,000	Legal, accounting, insurance, compliance
Reserve	8%	$120,000	Unexpected expenses, opportunistic investments

11.3 Milestones for Future Rounds

The seed funding is designed to achieve the milestones that justify a Series A raise. The primary milestones are: (1) Product launch with the full autonomous testing loop operational, including feature discovery, test execution, code analysis, fix engine, and production push; (2) 10,000+ total users across the open-source and cloud-hosted versions; (3) $100,000 MRR with validated unit economics demonstrating a path to profitability; (4) Net Revenue Retention of 120% or higher, indicating strong product-market fit and expansion potential.

Secondary milestones include: 5,000+ GitHub stars on the open-source repository, demonstrating community validation; at least three enterprise pilot customers in active evaluation; integration with GitHub Marketplace, VS Code, and at least two CI/CD platforms; and a Net Promoter Score of 50 or higher among active users. These milestones collectively demonstrate that Probato has achieved product-market fit and is ready to scale with additional capital.

The Series A round, targeted at $8-12 million, would fund the following initiatives: expansion of the engineering team from 7 to 18 people, building out enterprise features including SOC 2 compliance, on-premise deployment, and advanced security testing; scaling the sales team from 2 to 8 people to pursue enterprise accounts; expanding marketing to include paid acquisition channels, conference sponsorships, and content programs; and entering the AWS and Azure marketplaces to accelerate enterprise procurement. The Series A is expected to provide 24 months of runway, taking Probato through the point of cash-flow breakeven and into sustainable growth.